

Sandhya Dhanasekar

Impact Analyst

sandhyadhana17@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#)

PROFILE

Impact Analyst with hands-on experience designing outcome-tracking systems for organisational programmes, and a research background spanning behavioural science and media content analysis. Skilled in mixed-methods research, evidence synthesis and monitoring tools (Excel, Power BI, Python). **Equipped to turn evidence into action, I'm building toward my dream career in education/employment, climate and gender programming.**

KEY M&E PROJECT

Women's Empowerment Programme - Project Lead | *Department for Work and Pensions*

Milton Keynes, UK | Oct 2024 -Jan 2026

Multi-agency employment and English language programme for refugee and migrant women, delivered in partnership with an external skills provider.

- Designed a mixed-methods outcome-tracking framework for 24 participants across a 12-week English language programme and 8-week work placement, capturing indicators beyond employment outcomes: confidence, independent travel, social integration, language development and job readiness.
- Screened and selected participants through structured one-to-one vulnerability and needs assessments, ensuring programme targeting matched intended beneficiaries.
- Collected qualitative evidence, including individual participant case studies to document programme impact and support organisational learning and reporting.
- Coordinated with delivery partners throughout the programme lifecycle to ensure consistent data collection and monitoring of participant progress.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Universal Credit Work Coach | *Department for Work and Pensions*

Milton Keynes, UK | Oct 2024 – Jan 2026

Programme Monitoring & Reporting

- Designed and maintained an operational monitoring dashboard tracking engagement across Intensive Work Search programmes for a caseload of 230 claimants, integrating indicators including attendance, employment activity, job applications, Flexible Support Fund utilisation and sanctions into a single reporting tool.
- Used administrative data to identify claimant engagement trends and support evidence-based operational decision-making.
- Consolidated programme performance metrics into accessible reporting for frontline teams and managers, improving reporting efficiency and operational visibility.
- Analysed employee feedback from the UK Civil Service People Survey and prepared reports that informed local engagement initiatives, as part of the Milton Keynes Jobcentre People Engagement Team.

Programme Delivery & Inclusion

- Delivered an average of 15 personalised coaching appointments per day, supporting claimants facing diverse employment barriers including homelessness, disability, long-term unemployment and refugee resettlement.
- Promoted equitable access to government-funded employment programmes for vulnerable populations, including refugees, individuals with disabilities and those returning to work after extended career breaks.
- Recognised as Work Coach of the Month for four consecutive months (Jul–Oct 2025) for consistently high-quality claimant support and contribution to team objectives.
- Trained and mentored 3 new hires in my team, equipping them with digital and communication software to improve claimant engagement and team performance.

Behavioural Science Trainee - 1001 Stories

Bangalore, India | June 2022 – Aug 2022

Research & Evaluation Methods

- Co-designed survey instruments and discussion guides to collect qualitative insights while minimising researcher bias and leading questions.
- Conducted in-person interviews and synthesised findings from interviews, literature and desk research to identify recurring behavioural themes, a mixed-methods evidence synthesis process directly applicable to programme evaluation.
- Applied the COM-B behaviour change framework to interpret behavioural patterns and structure findings, demonstrating capability in applying analytical frameworks to real-world research questions.
- Translated complex qualitative research findings into client-ready reports and presentations for non-technical stakeholders.

Audit Assistant - M Sukumar & Associates

Chennai, India | Jan 2021 – Aug 2022

Evidence Verification & Data Quality

- Examined financial records and supporting documentation to verify compliance with accounting standards and statutory requirements, a verification process directly transferable to M&E data quality assurance.
- Analysed data to identify discrepancies, process inefficiencies and risks, contributing to accurate findings and recommendations.
- Prepared audit working papers ensuring evidence was organised, traceable and aligned with documentation requirements.

EDUCATION

MSc Behavioural Economics and Data Science | University of East Anglia | Sept 2022 – Sept 2023

- Dissertation (Evaluation focus): Evaluated the effectiveness of real-time feedback interventions on student residential energy consumption among 1st year university students using linear regression analysis - an applied impact evaluation assessing whether an intervention changed behavioural outcomes, concluding that awareness alone was insufficient and recommending more comprehensive intervention design.
- Second research project applied NLP and sentiment analysis to consumer attitudes towards purchasing sustainable apparel, demonstrating quantitative and text-analytic research capability.

B.A. Journalism | University of Madras | June 2017 – April 2020

- Media Research Project - Bylines by Women Journalists in Newspapers from 2017 -2019: An Analysis. Conducted a quantitative content analysis of gender representation in new stories published across three national Indian dailies (The Hindu, Times of India, The New Indian Express) across 2017 -2019 and editions, data scraping thousands of bylines by news beat to measure patterns in women's representation in print journalism.
- Designed a structured primary data framework to categorise articles by topic/beat, and synthesised findings against existing literature on gender and media, early experience in quantitative content analysis and gender-focused research design, transferable to gender-related monitoring and media/communications analysis work.

SKILLS

Monitoring, Evaluation & Learning: Programme Monitoring, Outcome Measurement, Qualitative Outcome Tracking, Impact Evaluation, Performance Indicators (KPIs), Dashboard Development, Data Collection & Validation, Evidence Synthesis, Programme Reporting

Research & Data Analysis: Mixed Methods Research, Survey Design, Qualitative & Quantitative Research, In-depth Interviews & Focus Groups, Statistical Analysis

Technical Tools: MS Excel, Power BI, Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, Kobo Toolbox, SurveyCTO, MS Office